applied to these rayon fabrics to improve their serviceability and to enhance their appearance. The most common finishes given to rayon fabrics are as follows :

Calendaring	For smoothness
Embossing	For decorative effects
Flame retardant	For fire protection
Napping	For warmth and softness and to resemble wool
Preshrinking	For greater dimensional stability
Stiffening	For better appearances
Water repellence	For resistance to water and rain
Wrinkle resistance	For better shape retention

3.2.4 Properties of Rayon

Shape	Thin long filament
Size	Diameter varies from 12 to 40 microns (controlled by the manufacturer)
Luster	Varies from brightness to dullness
Strength	2.4 – 3.0 Pa m^3/kg
Elongation	19 – 24%
Elasticity	82%
Density	1.5 g/cm^3 for all rayon types
Moisture	Upto 10.7%
Dimensional stability	Poor
Resistance to acids	Not good, but can be improved in special conditions
Resistance to alkalies	Not good, but can be improved in special conditions
Sunlight	Can withstand sunlight to an extent
Insects	Silver fish damages all type of cellulose fibres
Reaction to heat	Can withstand heat, but longer exposure will eventually degrade the fibre

3.2.5 Uses of Rayon

The uses of Rayon are:

- The rayon is used to create clothing such as blouse, jackets, sportswear and dresses.
- It is used in textile industry for making textile belts.
- Rayon is used for making tyre.
- It is also used for making carpets and surgical dressings.
- Rayon is used for a wide range of fabrics for household.



What is special about the year 2009?

The International Year of Natural Fibers is celebrated in 2009. It emphasizes on fibers produced by plants and animals. It does not include modern man-made artificial and synthetic fibers such as rayon, nylon, acrylic and polyester.

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